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News Weekly

Editor :
Advait K

Providing news to the Delaware Valley

LeBron James begins season No. 23, marking longest career in NBA history

As Los Angeles Lakers forward LeBron James took to the court at Crypto.com Arena Tuesday night to begin his 23rd season in the NBA, the 40-year-old added yet another record to his illustrious resumé – the longest career in league history. Prior to Tuesday, James shared the accolade with Vince Carter, who played 22 NBA seasons from 1998 to 2020.

"It was just fun to be out there with the guys, man. It's been rough mentally for me," the four-time NBA champion said after the game, "this is the first time I've started a basketball season and not played since I've started playing basketball, like nine years old, I've never missed the beginning of a basketball season."



A young child is among two individuals who were critically injured after a fire swept through a home in Chester, Pennsylvania.

Two people, including a young child, were hospitalized Wednesday night after flames tore through a home in Chester, Pennsylvania.

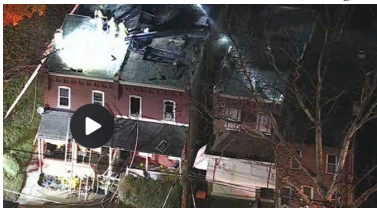
The fire broke out around 8:45 p.m. on the 200 block of Wilson Street.

The child remains in critical condition after being rescued from the second floor of the home.

An adult woman was also critically injured with burns suffered in the blaze.

Neighbors identified the injured as a mother and her baby. They said a second child was in the home at the time of the fire but was rescued.

"I talked to the woman. She was downstairs screaming that her baby was stuck upstairs, and she just wanted to get to her son," a neighbor recalled.



The DOJ acknowledges that not all grand jury members reviewed the final indictment against James Comey.

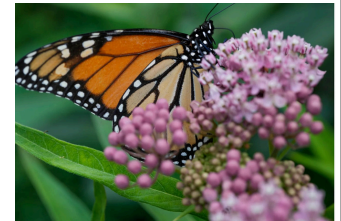
The Justice Department admitted Wednesday that not every member of the grand jury in former FBI Director James Comey's case saw the final version of the indictment, an error that could get the case thrown out. The rare admission of fault from the administration came toward the end of a hearing on Comey's arguments that the case should be dismissed because he's the victim of a "selective and vindictive" prosecution.



The Trump administration aims to reduce protections for endangered species and their habitats.

President Trump's administration moved Wednesday to roll back protections for imperiled species and the places they live, reviving a suite of changes to Endangered Species

Act regulations from the Republican's first term that were blocked under former Democratic President Joe Biden. The proposed changes include the elimination of the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service's "blanket rule" that automatically protects animals and plants when they are classified as threatened. Government agencies instead would have to craft species-specific rules for protections, a potentially lengthy process.



Conductive hydrogel mimics brain softness for flexible bioelectronic devices

Bioelectronics, such as implantable health monitors or devices that stimulate brain cells, are not as soft as the surrounding tissues due to their metal electronic circuits. A team of scientists from the University of Groningen in the Netherlands, led by associate professor Rajaraja Bose, have now developed a soft polymer hydrogel that can conduct electricity as well as metal can. As the material is both flexible and soft, it is more compatible with sensitive tissues. This finding has the potential for a large number of applications, for example, in biocompatible sensors and in wound healing. The scientists coated a porous hydrogel with the conductive polymer polypyrrole, using oxidative chemical vapor deposition. They applied an ultrathin layer to ensure that the gel would remain soft and stretchable. Tests showed that the coated gel was compatible with neural cells, making it a promising platform for soft, implantable, and biocompatible bioelectronics.

The conductive gel could be used in neural implants. Its high sensitivity and flexibility make this gel ideal for continuous monitoring of pressure, pulse, or muscle activity in smart health devices. As the gel is biocompatible and mimics the softness of tissues, it can also serve as a scaffold that supports cell growth and healing in damaged organs or nerves.



Multicellular cyanobacteria switch gene activity between day and night cycles

Cyanobacteria, also known as blue-green algae, occur worldwide in many varieties, including in single-cell form and in chains called filaments. While these tiny life forms can strongly influence many ecosystems, the details of their behavior have mostly been studied in laboratory settings, under constant illumination. But now, scientists at the Marine Biological Laboratory (MBL) have shown that filamentous cyanobacteria are strongly regulated by the day-night cycle they experience in their natural environment. Their study was published this week in mBio.

By analyzing gene expression in the cyanobacterium *Nostoc punctiforme*, the scientists discovered that during daylight, the cells focus on metabolism, precisely coordinating photosynthesis and carbon assimilation for cell division. But under cover of darkness, they turn to the control of genome repair and activate various genetic elements.

